HERMES WORKSPACE

Complete Installation Guide
From A to Z on Hostinger VPS
with auto-start services

By Dr. FIRAS

What you will learn

- How to set up your Hostinger VPS for Hermes Agent
- How to install Hermes Workspace with Docker
- How to expose the Hermes API gateway and dashboard
- How to connect Workspace to your Hermes backend
- How to set up auto-start services so everything survives reboots
- How to access your dashboard from any browser

OK Final result: A fully featured AI agent platform with chat, memory, skills, kanban tasks, terminal, files browser, and multi-agent orchestration - all running on your own VPS, accessible from anywhere.

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1. Prerequisites

Before starting, make sure you have the following ready:

- **A Hostinger VPS account** (KVM 2 plan or higher recommended)
- **An Anthropic API key** from https://console.anthropic.com/settings/keys
- **Basic command-line knowledge** (copy and paste is enough)
- **A modern web browser** (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge)
- **About 30 minutes** of your time

2. Get your Hostinger VPS

Hostinger offers a one-click Hermes Agent deployment that includes Docker, Traefik (with automatic SSL), and Hermes preinstalled.

> ***** Use coupon code **GOHERMES** at https://www.hostinger.fr/gohermes to get the best price on your VPS.

Recommended plan

The **KVM 2 plan** (2 vCPU, 8 GB RAM, 100 GB NVMe) is enough to run Hermes Agent + Hermes Workspace + Docker comfortably.

During Hostinger setup

- Select the **Hermes Agent** template when prompted (one-click install)
- Choose a server location close to your audience
- Set a strong root password (you will need it later)
- Wait 2-3 minutes for the deployment to finish

3. Connect to your VPS

You can connect to your VPS in two different ways:

Option A - Browser terminal (easiest)

From the Hostinger hPanel, go to **VPS** → **your server** → **Browser terminal**. This opens a terminal directly in your browser, no SSH client required.

Option B - SSH from your computer

On Mac or Linux, open a terminal. On Windows, use PowerShell or PuTTY:

```
ssh root@YOUR_VPS_IP
```

Replace **YOUR_VPS_IP** with the IPv4 address shown in your Hostinger dashboard.

Find your IPv4 address

Once you are connected to your VPS, run this command to display your public IPv4 address (do not use IPv6 - it will not work for our setup):

```
curl -4 ifconfig.me
```

Write down this IP - you will need it several times in the next steps.

4. Locate your Hermes installation

The Hostinger Hermes template installs Hermes Agent automatically as a Docker container. Let's verify it's running:

```
docker ps
```

You should see a container with a name like **hermes-agent-XXXX-hermes-agent-1**. Note this full name - you will use it in many commands. **In this guide we will call it CONTAINER_NAME**.

Find the Hermes folder

Hostinger stores the Hermes Docker setup in **/docker/**. List its content:

```
ls /docker/
```

You will see a folder like **hermes-agent-aff1** (the suffix is unique to your installation). **Throughout this guide we will call it HERMES_DIR**.

Save your paths in shell variables

Run these commands to save the path and container name for the rest of this session (replace with your actual values):

```
export HERMES_DIR=/docker/hermes-agent-aff1
export CONTAINER_NAME=hermes-agent-aff1-hermes-agent-1
```

> **i** From now on you can use **$HERMES_DIR** and **$CONTAINER_NAME** in commands instead of typing the full names. This works only in the current SSH session.

5. Configure the Hermes API gateway

Hermes Workspace needs to talk to Hermes Agent through its HTTP API. By default this API is disabled - we need to enable it.

Generate a strong secret key

Run this command and **copy the output** - we'll need it several times:

```
openssl rand -hex 32
```

> **! SAVE THIS KEY!** Throughout this guide we'll call it **YOUR_SECRET_KEY**. You will reuse it in steps 8 and 9.

Edit the Hermes environment file

```
nano $HERMES_DIR/data/.env
```

Add these four lines at the end of the file. Replace **YOUR_SECRET_KEY** with the key you generated above:

```
API_SERVER_ENABLED=true
API_SERVER_HOST=0.0.0.0
API_SERVER_PORT=8642
API_SERVER_KEY=YOUR_SECRET_KEY
```

Save with Ctrl+X then Y then Enter.

6. Expose ports 8642 and 9119 in Docker

The Hostinger Hermes container only exposes port 4860 (the web terminal) by default. We need to expose two more ports:

- **Port 8642** - Hermes API gateway (chat, models, streaming)
- **Port 9119** - Hermes dashboard (sessions, skills, config, jobs)

Edit the docker-compose file

```
nano $HERMES_DIR/docker-compose.yml
```

Find the **ports:** section under **hermes-agent:**. It currently looks like this:

```
ports:
- "4860"
```

Replace it with:

```
ports:
- "4860"
- "8642:8642"
- "9119:9119"
```

Save with Ctrl+X then Y then Enter.

Apply the changes

```
cd $HERMES_DIR
docker compose up -d
```

Verify with:

```
docker compose ps
```

You should now see **4860**, **8642**, and **9119** in the PORTS column.

7. Install Hermes Workspace

Now we'll clone the Hermes Workspace repository into **/docker/** next to the existing Hermes installation.

Clone the repository

```
cd /docker
git clone https://github.com/outsourc-e/hermes-workspace
cd hermes-workspace
```

Verify the files are present

```
ls -la
```

You should see **docker-compose.yml**, **.env.example**, and other Workspace files.

Copy the example environment file

```
cp .env.example .env
```

i We will customize this **.env** file in the next step.

8. Configure the Workspace environment

Open the Workspace environment file:

```
nano /docker/hermes-workspace/.env
```

Add these lines at the end of the file. Replace **YOUR_SECRET_KEY** with the same key from step 5:

```
HERMES_API_URL=http://127.0.0.1:8642
HERMES_API_TOKEN=YOUR_SECRET_KEY
HERMES_PASSWORD=YOUR_SECRET_KEY
COOKIE_SECURE=0
HOST=0.0.0.0
```

! HERMES_API_TOKEN must be EXACTLY the same value as **API_SERVER_KEY** from step 5. Otherwise the connection will fail with HTTP 401.

Add your Anthropic API key

In the same .env file, find the line starting with **# ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=** and uncomment it (remove the #), then add your real key:

```
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=sk-ant-api03-XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
```

Save with Ctrl+X then Y then Enter.

9. Override the docker-compose configuration

The default **docker-compose.yml** from Hermes Workspace tries to start its own Hermes Agent container. Since we already have Hermes running on Hostinger, we need to override this file to use our existing installation.

Backup the original file

```
cp /docker/hermes-workspace/docker-compose.yml \
/docker/hermes-workspace/docker-compose.yml.backup
```

Replace the docker-compose file

```
nano /docker/hermes-workspace/docker-compose.yml
```

Delete everything in the file and replace it with this minimal configuration. Replace **YOUR_SECRET_KEY** with your actual key:

```
services:
hermes-workspace:
image: ghcr.io/outsourc-e/hermes-workspace:latest
network_mode: "host"
env_file:
- .env
environment:
HERMES_API_URL: http://127.0.0.1:8642
HERMES_API_TOKEN: YOUR_SECRET_KEY
HERMES_PASSWORD: YOUR_SECRET_KEY
COOKIE_SECURE: "0"
PORT: "3002"
HOST: "0.0.0.0"
```

Save with Ctrl+X then Y then Enter.

> **i** We use **network_mode: host** so Workspace can directly reach Hermes on 127.0.0.1:8642 and 127.0.0.1:9119 without Docker network complications.

10. Open firewall port 3002

Hostinger's firewall blocks all incoming traffic by default. We need to explicitly allow port 3002 so we can access Hermes Workspace from a browser.

Add the firewall rule in hPanel

- Go to **https://hpanel.hostinger.com**
- Click on **VPS** in the menu
- Select your server
- In the left sidebar, click **Security** → **Firewall**
- Click **Create firewall configuration** if needed (name it 'hermes')
- Add a new rule with these values:

Field	Value
Action	Accept
Protocol	TCP
Port	3002
Source	Any

Click **Add rule** to apply.

> **!** Without this rule, http://YOUR_VPS_IP:3002 will time out from any external browser even if the container is running.

11. Start Hermes Workspace

Launch the container

```
cd /docker/hermes-workspace
docker compose up -d
```

Docker will pull the image (about 200 MB, takes 1-2 minutes) and start the container.

Verify the container is running

```
docker compose ps
```

Status should be **Up**. If it shows **Restarting** or **Exited**, check the logs:

```
docker compose logs hermes-workspace --tail=50
```

Test from inside the VPS

```
curl http://localhost:3002
```

If you see HTML output, Workspace is running. Now test from your browser:

```
http://YOUR_VPS_IP:3002
```

(Replace YOUR_VPS_IP with the IPv4 address from step 3.)

12. Auto-start the Hermes gateway

The Hostinger Hermes container runs a web terminal by default but does **not** auto-start the API gateway. We'll create a systemd service that launches it automatically and restarts it if it crashes.

Create the systemd service file

```
nano /etc/systemd/system/hermes-gateway.service
```

Paste this content (replace **CONTAINER_NAME** with your actual container name from step 4):

```
[Unit]
Description=Hermes Gateway Auto-Start
After=docker.service
Requires=docker.service

[Service]
Type=simple
ExecStartPre=/bin/sleep 10
ExecStart=/usr/bin/docker exec CONTAINER_NAME hermes gateway run
Restart=always
RestartSec=15

[Install]
WantedBy=multi-user.target
```

Save with Ctrl+X then Y then Enter.

Enable and start the service

```
systemctl daemon-reload
systemctl enable hermes-gateway.service
systemctl start hermes-gateway.service
```

Verify the gateway is up

```
sleep 15
curl http://localhost:8642/health \
-H "Authorization: Bearer YOUR_SECRET_KEY"
```

Expected response:

```
{"status": "ok", "platform": "hermes-agent"}
```

13. Auto-start the Hermes dashboard

The Hermes dashboard exposes the extended APIs (Sessions, Skills, Config, Jobs, MCP). Without it, Workspace will show partial features. Let's auto-start the dashboard the same way we did the gateway.

Create the dashboard service file

```
nano /etc/systemd/system/hermes-dashboard.service
```

Paste this content (replace **CONTAINER_NAME** with your actual container name):

```
[Unit]
Description=Hermes Dashboard Auto-Start
After=docker.service hermes-gateway.service
Requires=docker.service

[Service]
Type=simple
ExecStartPre=/bin/sleep 20
ExecStart=/usr/bin/docker exec CONTAINER_NAME hermes dashboard --host 0.0.0.0 --port
9119 --no-open --insecure
Restart=always
RestartSec=15

[Install]
WantedBy=multi-user.target
```

Save with Ctrl+X then Y then Enter.

> **i** The **--insecure** flag is required because the dashboard refuses by default to bind on 0.0.0.0. In our Docker setup this is safe because the port 9119 is only reachable from the local Workspace container.

Enable and start the service

```
systemctl daemon-reload
systemctl enable hermes-dashboard.service
systemctl start hermes-dashboard.service
```

Verify the dashboard is up

```
sleep 30
curl http://localhost:9119/api/health
```

If you see **{"detail":"Unauthorized"}**, that's perfect! It means the dashboard is running and responding. Workspace will authenticate with its own internal token.

14. Connect Workspace to Hermes

Open your Hermes Workspace in the browser:

```
http://YOUR_VPS_IP:3002
```

You should see the welcome screen. Follow these steps:

First-time setup wizard

1. Click **Connect Backend**
2. Wait a few seconds - the connection should validate automatically (green dot)
3. Click **Continue**
4. On the provider selection screen, choose **Anthropic**
5. Paste your Anthropic API key (the same one from step 8)
6. Select a model (e.g. **claude-sonnet-4-6** or **claude-opus-4-7**)
7. Click **Continue** to test the chat
8. Type any message - if you get a reply, you're done!

> **!** If you see **HTTP 401** at this stage, double-check that HERMES_API_TOKEN in /docker/hermes-workspace/.env matches API_SERVER_KEY in the Hermes .env exactly (no spaces, no quotes).

15. Final verification

Your Hermes Workspace is now fully installed with auto-start services. Take a moment to explore the main features:

- **Dashboard** - Real-time stats: sessions, tokens, API calls, top models
- **Chat** - Full conversation interface with your Hermes Agent
- **Sessions** - All your past conversations, searchable
- **Memory** - Browse and edit what your agent remembers
- **Skills** - 60+ skills your agent can use out of the box
- **Files** - Workspace file browser with code editor
- **Terminal** - PTY terminal directly in the browser
- **Tasks / Conductor** - Kanban-style project management
- **Operations / Swarm** - Multi-agent dashboard and orchestration
- **MCP** - Connect external tools via Model Context Protocol

Confirm everything is running

```
# Check both services are active
systemctl status hermes-gateway.service
systemctl status hermes-dashboard.service

# Check all containers are up
docker ps
```

> **OK CONGRATULATIONS!** Your Hermes Workspace is fully operational. After any reboot, both the gateway and dashboard will start automatically.

Daily usage

From now on, just open this URL in any browser to use Hermes Workspace:

```
http://YOUR_VPS_IP:3002
```

Troubleshooting

HTTP 401 - Invalid bearer token

Your **HERMES_API_TOKEN** in /docker/hermes-workspace/.env doesn't match **API_SERVER_KEY** in the Hermes /data/.env. Make sure they are identical (no leading spaces, no quotes). After changing, restart both containers and the systemd services.

Site cannot be reached on port 3002

Check that:

- The firewall rule for port 3002 is active in hPanel (step 10)
- The container is running: **docker compose ps**
- You're using the IPv4 address, not IPv6
- You're using **http://** (not https://) for direct VPS access

Connection reset on port 8642 or 9119

The Hermes gateway or dashboard is not running. Restart the systemd services:

```
systemctl restart hermes-gateway.service
systemctl restart hermes-dashboard.service
```

Active Model shows 'Offline'

The gateway is unreachable. Run:

```
systemctl status hermes-gateway.service
journalctl -u hermes-gateway.service -n 50
```

'Hermes Agent Settings - Not available'

The dashboard is not running. Restart it:

```
systemctl restart hermes-dashboard.service
sleep 30
curl http://localhost:9119/api/health
```

Expected response: **{"detail":"Unauthorized"}** (this confirms the dashboard is up).

View live logs

To monitor what's happening in real-time:

```
# Workspace logs
cd /docker/hermes-workspace && docker compose logs -f

# Hermes container logs
cd /docker/hermes-agent-aff1 && docker compose logs -f

# Gateway service logs
journalctl -u hermes-gateway.service -f

# Dashboard service logs
```

```
journalctl -u hermes-dashboard.service -f
```

Daily commands cheat sheet

Keep this page handy. These are the commands you'll use most often.

Check that everything is running

```
# All containers
docker ps

# Both auto-start services
systemctl status hermes-gateway.service
systemctl status hermes-dashboard.service
```

Restart everything

```
# Restart Hermes Agent container
cd /docker/hermes-agent-aff1 && docker compose restart

# Restart Workspace container
cd /docker/hermes-workspace && docker compose restart

# Restart auto-start services
systemctl restart hermes-gateway.service
systemctl restart hermes-dashboard.service
```

Update Hermes Workspace to latest version

```
cd /docker/hermes-workspace
docker compose pull
docker compose up -d
```

Update Hermes Agent to latest version

```
cd /docker/hermes-agent-aff1
docker compose pull
docker compose up -d
systemctl restart hermes-gateway.service
systemctl restart hermes-dashboard.service
```

Backup your Hermes data

```
tar -czf hermes-backup-$(date +%F).tar.gz \
/docker/hermes-agent-aff1/data \
/docker/hermes-workspace/.env
```

Stop everything

```
systemctl stop hermes-dashboard.service
systemctl stop hermes-gateway.service
cd /docker/hermes-workspace && docker compose down
cd /docker/hermes-agent-aff1 && docker compose down
```

Resources & Support

Official documentation

Hermes Agent: https://github.com/NousResearch/hermes-agent

Hermes Workspace: https://github.com/outsourc-e/hermes-workspace

Hermes docs: https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/docs/

Anthropic console: https://console.anthropic.com/settings/keys

Hostinger hPanel: https://hpanel.hostinger.com

Get your VPS

* **HERMES SERVER** with coupon **GOHERMES** at https://www.hostinger.fr/gohermes

Quick reference - All key files

File	Purpose
`/docker/hermes-agent-aff1/data/.env`	`Hermes Agent secrets`
`/docker/hermes-agent-aff1/docker-compose.yml`	`Hermes Docker config`
`/docker/hermes-workspace/.env`	`Workspace config`
`/docker/hermes-workspace/docker-compose.yml`	`Workspace Docker config`
`/etc/systemd/system/hermes-gateway.service`	`Gateway auto-start`
`/etc/systemd/system/hermes-dashboard.service`	`Dashboard auto-start`

Guide created by Dr. FIRAS

AI & Automation Expert

Watch the full video tutorial on YouTube